Jacob Z. Eliason

jacobeliason@gmail.com | +1-801-473-3549 Based in Arlington, VA, USA
github.com/jcblsn | linkedin.com/in/jacobzeliason | jacobeliason.com

Summary

Senior data scientist with experience building and evaluating production LLM tools for policy enforcement and safety escalation. Practiced at combining statistical rigor with personal ownership of evaluation design, policy interpretation, monitoring, and tooling for operational teams.

Experience

Thumbtack Remote, USA
Senior Data Scientist Mar 2025 – Present
- Own data science for marketplace refunds, with heavy cross-functional work across Trust & Safety, Pricing, and Service Operations.
- Conceived of and built, from zero to one, AutoReferee, an LLM system that approves or denies refund requests and is now responsible for one-third of refund request decisions and refunds equal to 1.3% of total revenue.
    - Ideated, prototyped, socialized; owned decision logic, evaluation, and monitoring; partnered with Engineering on integration; presented to company in All Hands meeting.
- Led migration of LLM-based Trust & Safety system for refund requests during a five-week vendor transition period: constructed evaluation set, wrote benchmark harness, and coordinated corrections and launch criteria with T&S and Risk Analytics.
    - Used improved hand-rolled system to run a retrospective review of 80k requests and identify follow-up cases for Trust & Safety action.
    - Built custom evaluation tooling in Databricks to aid Risk Analytics in revising policy guidance, comparing prompts, and inspecting case-level predictions without developer tools.
- Created data models, Looker monitoring and decision-inspection dashboards, and alerts covering approval and escalation rates, overrides, latency, and cost; investigated production anomalies and implemented fixes with Engineering.
- Designed and implemented using causal inference a refund-credit experiment that challenged the revenue rationale for $3 million in annual spending, diagnosed implementation failures, and informed the team's subsequent strategy.

AvalonBay Communities Arlington, VA, USA
Senior Data Scientist Apr 2024 – Feb 2025
- Operated as internal consultant and partner to revenue management and marketing analytics teams, providing strategic support via causal inference, A/B testing, and survey research projects. Received company recognition for improved accuracy in prospect forecast model.

Guidehouse Arlington, VA, USA
Data Scientist – Senior Consultant Aug 2023 – Apr 2024
- Deployed and maintained the backend of a reporting tool used by several hundred employees for a U.S. Department of State client.

United States Agency for International Development – via DevTech Systems Washington, DC, USA
Statistician Feb 2022 – Aug 2022
- Applied statistical disclosure limitation tools to protect sensitive personal data; held a Secret clearance for the role.

United States Census Bureau Washington, DC, USA
Mathematical Statistician Sep 2020 – Feb 2022
- Developed production programs for the Survey of Income and Program Participation related to sampling, weighting, and variance estimation using SAS, SQL, and R; calculated metrics and drafted text for nonresponse bias reports.

Y2 Analytics Salt Lake City, UT, USA
Data Analyst Jan 2020 – Aug 2020
- Delivered survey research to municipal government clients from questionnaire design through statistical analysis and client reporting.

Education

The London School of Economics and Political Science London, United Kingdom
M.Sc. Statistics Sep 2022 – Aug 2023

Brigham Young University Provo, UT, United States
B.S. Statistics Jan 2016 – Dec 2019

Skills

LLM evaluation: Evaluation design, human labeling and adjudication, model and prompt benchmarking, error analysis, production monitoring
Statistical methods: Experimental design, causal inference, sampling, uncertainty estimation

Programming and AI: Python, R, SQL, DSPy, Claude Code
Data and reporting: dbt, Looker, BigQuery, Databricks

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